

The SRM 'Dream' University - The Gateway to International Education

Only a few months to go, and it will be that time of the year again when students who pass out of school are expected to make a life-defining choice.....the choice of the college/university where they would be pursuing higher education. With tens of institutions jumping on to the education band-wagon every year, students' are indeed faced with a tough task of picking the 'right one', especially when almost all institutions claim to provide "quality education that meets international standards"! By "internationalization", most educational institutions either mean that they have a curriculum that meets global standards, or an infrastructure that is world-class. But, only an institution that clearly understands the meaning of "internationalization" of education, and is truly committed to the academic and all-round development of its students, can provide them with the opportunity to actually visit a "foreign university" for a short period and experience "first-hand", true INTERNATIONALISM! The SRM University provides its students with this "dream" opportunity.... Not once, not twice, but year after year! This university, which has spent decades in educating and enabling the holistic development of students, has advocated a unique "Semester Abroad" programme, also known as the "SRM 100" programme. Under this banner, annually, nearly 100 deserving students from the university are sent to renowned institutions abroad for one semester, at a very reasonable cost. In the current year alone, 58 students have received this 'once-in-a-lifetime' chance, of which 6 students have been sent to the prestigious MIT with scholarship. Besides helping students gain adequate insight into educational systems abroad, this real-time exposure to an alien milieu sharpens the survival instincts and instills self-reliance in the students.

Students who miss out on this opportunity will have no reason to feel depressed, as the SRM University has signed 22 MOUs with acclaimed universities world-wide for the exchange of students and staff. This means, that eminent

lecturers and students from around the world will troop into the university campus itself to educate and interact with its inmates. SRM has international faculty to value add to its curriculum and teaching practices. This interaction enables the students to understand and appreciate each other's cultures, and also serves as an effective platform for sharing knowledge. Moreover, the feedback from such students and teachers helps the university to fine-tune its own curriculum and teaching patterns, so that they are commensurate to international benchmarks.

In addition to these inputs, valuable recommendations provided by the SRM University's very-own International Advisory Board ensure that the SRM university's curriculum stays current and absolutely international in content and quality. The board, which comprises of professors from renowned foreign universities such as MIT, Carnegie Melon, Cambridge, etc., periodically reviews the college curriculum in the light of changing teaching trends and student needs, and suggests improvements in teaching methodologies and the introduction of new courses.

It is only owing to this global outlook, and continuous efforts to adapt to the demands of time, that the once modest SRM Engineering College, has now grown enormously to become a full-fledged SRM University, offering a plethora of programs in higher education, and spanning a mammoth 3 campuses the Kattankulathur campus, the Ramapuram campus, and the Modi Nagar campus in New Delhi. The Kattankulathur campus, the largest of the three, is home to the faculties of Medical Sciences, Engineering and Technology, and Science and Humanities. The Ramapuram campus holds the distinction of housing the reputed SRM College of Dentistry,

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